nites, Campanians, Umbrians) and organized in somewhat similar fashion to the legion. However, each ala had fewer Velites and Triarii, the differences between the Hastati and Principes tended to disappear, and, because they were usually better at that sort of thing, they had three times the cavalry contingent as did the legion. Each ala also had elite cohorts of infantry, the *extraordinarii*, and there was a similar cavalry unit for every two alae. In all, the organization of each ala more strongly resembled the legion of the Empire than that of the Republic. By the time of Marius, the alae disappeared to become regular legions, and the word ala then referred to cavalry.